

Uttar Pradesh Ration Card & Public Distribution System

The Complete Reference: Law, Eligibility, Documents, Certificates, Application Process, Digital Systems, Procurement, Grievances & Facts/Figures

Compiled as a knowledge-base / dataset-training reference for the Public Distribution Scheme (Ration) and Welfare Scheme project

Scope: Uttar Pradesh only. Official portals referenced: fcs.up.gov.in, edistrict.up.gov.in (esathi.up.gov.in), familyid.up.gov.in, nfsa.up.gov.in, dfpd.gov.in, fci.gov.in

All facts and figures in this document are drawn from published government sources (PIB, DFPD, FCI, Economic Survey, PRS Legislative Research) and reputable secondary guides, with sources cited at the end of each section. Where a specific UP-level statistic is not publicly available in verifiable form, this document says so explicitly rather than estimating.

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1. Introduction

A Ration Card in Uttar Pradesh is an official document issued by the Department of Food & Civil Supplies (Khadya Evam Rasad Vibhag) that entitles eligible households to buy subsidised — and since January 2023, largely free — food grains (wheat, rice, and coarse grains/millets) from Fair Price Shops (FPS) under the National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013. Uttar Pradesh operates one of the largest Public Distribution Systems (PDS) in the country.

According to figures compiled from the FCS UP portal and secondary aggregators, Uttar Pradesh has over 3.6 crore ration cards covering around 14.6 crore beneficiaries, distributed through more than 80,000 Fair Price Shops spread across all 75 districts of the state. This makes UP's PDS network the largest of any single state in India by beneficiary count.

Beyond food subsidy, the ration card doubles as a supporting identity and address-proof document accepted for several other government services, and — together with the Family ID (Ek Parivar Ek Pehchan) — acts as an entry point into the wider welfare ecosystem in UP, including pension schemes, scholarships, and schemes such as Kanya Sumangala Yojana.

Source: fcs.up.gov.in aggregated via CitizenNest and India Customer Care guides

2. History & Evolution of the Ration Card System

2.1 Origins in India

Rationing in India traces back to World War II-era food scarcity in the 1940s, when the colonial government introduced grain rationing in select cities. After independence, the system was gradually expanded and formalised into the Public Distribution System (PDS), which for decades operated as a general entitlement scheme without strict income-based targeting.

2.2 Shift to Targeted PDS (1997)

In June 1997, the Government of India launched the Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS), which for the first time distinguished Below Poverty Line (BPL) and Above Poverty Line (APL) households, aiming to direct subsidies more specifically toward poorer households rather than the population at large.

2.3 Antyodaya Anna Yojana (2000)

On 25 December 2000, the Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY) was launched as a special sub-scheme within TPDS to identify and support the 'poorest of the poor' — households such as those headed by widows, disabled persons, elderly people without support, and other highly vulnerable groups — with a larger, low-cost monthly foodgrain entitlement.

2.4 National Food Security Act, 2013

The National Food Security Act (NFSA), also called the Right to Food Act, was passed by Parliament on 5 July 2013 (signed into law 12 September 2013, retroactively effective from 5 July 2013) under the UPA government led by Prime Minister Manmohan Singh. This converted food subsidy from a discretionary welfare scheme into a legal entitlement for eligible households, covering PDS, the midday meal scheme, and maternity entitlements under one umbrella law.

2.5 Digitisation Era (2014 onward)

From the mid-2010s, states including Uttar Pradesh progressively digitised ration card databases, seeded Aadhaar numbers against beneficiary records, and rolled out electronic Point of Sale (e-PoS) devices at Fair Price Shops for biometric authentication — aimed at removing duplicate/bogus cards ('ghost beneficiaries') and improving last-mile delivery accuracy.

2.6 COVID-19 and PMGKAY (2020–2023)

The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY) was launched on 26 March 2020 in response to the COVID-19 pandemic, initially providing an additional 5 kg of free foodgrain and 1 kg of pulses per person per month, on top of regular NFSA entitlements, to roughly 80 crore beneficiaries nationwide. It was extended in phases through 2020–2022.

2.7 Integration of PMGKAY into NFSA (2023–2028)

From 1 January 2023, the government merged PMGKAY into NFSA and began providing the standard NFSA entitlement (5 kg/person/month for Priority Households, 35 kg/household/month for AAY) completely free of cost, rather than at the earlier subsidised prices of Rs. 1–3/kg. This arrangement has since been extended for a further five years, through December 2028.

2.8 One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC)

ONORC, rolled out nationally by mid-2020s, allows any NFSA cardholder to draw their entitlement from any Fair Price Shop in the country using Aadhaar-based biometric or OTP authentication, benefiting migrant workers in particular. Uttar Pradesh, both as a large source state for migrant labour and a destination state, is a full participant in ONORC.

Source: Business Standard; PubAdmin Institute; PMFIAS; Grokipedia summary of NFSA, 2013; DFPD notifications

3. Legal Framework: National Food Security Act, 2013

The NFSA is the central law underpinning ration card entitlements everywhere in India, including Uttar Pradesh. Key provisions relevant to beneficiaries:

- Coverage: up to 75% of the rural population and up to 50% of the urban population are legally entitled to subsidised/free foodgrains — together, about two-thirds of India's population nationally.
- Two beneficiary categories: Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY) households (poorest of the poor) and Priority Households (PHH), identified by state governments using prescribed criteria.
- Entitlement quantities: AAY households get 35 kg of foodgrain per household per month; PHH beneficiaries get 5 kg per person per month.
- Legislated prices (pre-2023): not exceeding Rs. 3/kg for rice, Rs. 2/kg for wheat, and Rs. 1/kg for coarse grains — foodgrains have been provided free of cost since January 2023 under the PMGKAY–NFSA merger.
- Women's empowerment provision: the eldest woman of the household, aged 18 years or above, is to be recognised as the head of household for the purpose of issuing the ration card, unless no adult woman is available.
- Food Security Allowance: if entitled foodgrains are not supplied to a beneficiary in a given month, the State Government is legally required to pay a Food Security Allowance, under the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015.
- Grievance redressal: every district is required to have a District Grievance Redressal Officer (DGRO) empowered to hear PDS-related complaints, alongside State Food Commissions constituted under the Act.
- Transparency provisions: PDS-related records (allocation, offtake, FPS-wise beneficiary lists) are required to be disclosed publicly — this is the legal basis for the eligibility lists published on fcs.up.gov.in and nfsa.up.gov.in.
- Decentralised procurement: the Act permits state governments/agencies to procure, store, and distribute foodgrains within the state directly (with central government reimbursement), rather than relying solely on central pool stocks routed through the Food Corporation of India (FCI).

Source: dfpd.gov.in — National Food Security Act, 2013 (Act No. 20 of 2013); PRS Legislative Research; PMFIAS

4. Types of Ration Cards Issued in UP

Card Type	Who it is for	Monthly Entitlement	Current Price (as of Jan 2023 onward)
Antyodaya Anna Yojana (AAY)	Poorest of the poor — no regular income, widows, disabled persons, elderly without support, primitive tribal households	35 kg foodgrain per household	Free of cost (was Rs. 1–3/kg prior to Jan 2023)
Priority Household (PHH)	Families meeting BPL/NFSA criteria based on SECC data and state income limits	5 kg foodgrain per person	Free of cost (was Rs. 1–3/kg prior to Jan 2023)
Eligible Household (EHH)	UP-specific NFSA sub-category for certain additional vulnerable groups	As per state notification	Free of cost under NFSA-PMGKAY merger

Non-NFSA / APL	Households above the NFSA income threshold	Minimal or nil subsidy	Market/near-market rate where applicable
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Note: Card colour coding used historically in UP: yellow for AAY, and typically white/other colours for PHH and Non-NFSA cards, though exact colour conventions can vary by district printing format — the card category label is the authoritative marker, not colour alone.

Source: CitizenNest; ClearTax; dfpd.gov.in NFSA notification (free foodgrain S.O. 6148(E))

5. Eligibility Criteria (Detailed)

5.1 General eligibility to apply

- Must be a permanent resident of Uttar Pradesh with valid address proof in the state.
- Must be at least 18 years old to apply as head of the family.
- The family must not already hold a valid ration card anywhere else in India.
- Annual family income must be below the state-prescribed limit — commonly cited as up to Rs. 2 lakh/year for rural households and Rs. 3 lakh/year for urban households (these limits are set/revised by the state government; always confirm the current limit on fcs.up.gov.in).
- Newly married couples without an existing card, and holders of expired/temporary cards, can apply for a fresh regular card.

5.2 AAY-specific eligibility (poorest-of-the-poor priority)

- Households headed by widows, disabled persons, or persons aged 60 years or more with no assured means of subsistence or societal support.
- Primitive tribal households, and households with no regular source of income.
- Landless agricultural labourers, marginal farmers, rickshaw pullers, hand-cart pullers, cobblers, and similarly placed casual/informal workers, per broader central AAY guidelines adopted by states.

5.3 Exclusion criteria (commonly applied)

- Income-tax payers or professional-tax payers in the household.
- Government employees above certain grade levels.
- Owners of four-wheeler motor vehicles (excluding those used commercially, per some state guidelines).
- Households already covered under a ration card in another state (until surrendered).

Note: Exact income limits and exclusion criteria are revised periodically by the state government; the figures above reflect commonly cited thresholds in recent secondary reporting and should be reconfirmed on fcs.up.gov.in before an application is filed.

Source: India Customer Care; CitizenNest guides

6. Documents Required for a New Ration Card

Collect the following before starting an application, either online at fcs.up.gov.in / your nearest CSC, or offline at the Tehsil Supply Office:

Document	Purpose	Where to obtain it
Aadhaar Card (all family members)	Primary identity proof; e-KYC and biometric linking is mandatory	UIDAI enrolment centre / Aadhaar Seva Kendra
Family ID (Ek Parivar Ek Pehchan)	Unique 12-digit household ID required by many UP welfare portals	familyid.up.gov.in
Proof of Residence	Confirms UP address — electricity bill, water bill, rent agreement, bank passbook, or Voter ID	Utility provider / bank / rent-deed registrar
Income Certificate (Aay Praman Patra)	Required especially for PHH/AAY category applications	edistrict.up.gov.in (esathi.up.gov.in) — Tehsildar
Passport-size Photograph	Photo of the head of family	Any photo studio, or Aadhaar photo option on portal
Bank Account Details / Passbook	Linked for direct benefit transfer and identity verification	Your bank branch
Mobile Number (linked to Aadhaar)	OTP verification during application and card downloads	Your telecom provider
Domicile Certificate (if applicable)	Sometimes sought for specific welfare linkages	edistrict.up.gov.in — Tehsildar/SDM/ADM
Caste Certificate (if applicable)	For reserved-category benefit linkage alongside ration entitlements	edistrict.up.gov.in — Tehsildar/SDM/ADM
Disability Certificate (if applicable, for AAY)	Supports AAY priority-category classification for disabled applicants	Chief Medical Officer (CMO) office / district hospital
Death Certificate (for member removal)	Required to delete a deceased member from the card	Nagar Nigam/Nagar Palika (urban) or Gram Panchayat (rural) via edistrict.up.gov.in
Marriage Certificate (for new household split)	Supports issuing a separate card to a newly married couple	edistrict.up.gov.in / Sub-Registrar office

Note: The government does not charge any fee for issuing a ration card itself. CSC/Jan Seva Kendra operators may charge a nominal service fee, typically around Rs. 10–30.

Source: Tribune India; India Customer Care; CitizenNest guides

6.1 Aadhaar Card

Aadhaar, issued by UIDAI, is the base identity document for nearly every step of the ration card process — application, e-KYC, and biometric authentication at the Fair Price Shop.

1. Locate your nearest Aadhaar Seva Kendra or bank-based enrolment centre.

2. Carry an existing ID/address proof (birth certificate, school ID, existing ration card, etc.) for first-time enrolment.
3. Complete biometric capture (fingerprints, iris, photograph) at the centre.
4. Aadhaar is generated and posted, and is also downloadable from uidai.gov.in once ready.

Updating Aadhaar details

Name, address, date of birth, or mobile number can be updated online (for some fields) or at an Aadhaar Seva Kendra. Address updates in particular are relevant before a ration card application, since the e-KYC pulls the address on record.

Source: UIDAI general enrolment guidance

6.2 Family ID (Ek Parivar Ek Pehchan)

The UP Family ID is a unique 12-digit identification number assigned to each household, consolidating family details for streamlined access to ration cards, pensions, scholarships, and other welfare schemes. If your family already holds a ration card, the card number itself typically becomes/links to the Family ID; households without a ration card register fresh.

How to apply

5. Visit familyid.up.gov.in and select New Registration.
6. Choose 'Ration Card holder' if you already have a ration card (the system pulls existing family data), or 'Naya Pehchan' (New Identity) if you do not.
7. Enter the head of family's Aadhaar number and verify via OTP sent to the Aadhaar-linked mobile number.
8. Fill in details of all family members and submit.

Note: Processing is largely instant to a few days depending on data-matching accuracy. There is no fee for Family ID registration.

Source: egovtschemes.com; pppfamilyiid.com — UP Family ID guides

6.3 Income Certificate (Aay Praman Patra)

Issued by the Revenue Department through the local Tehsildar; certifies the applicant/family's income from all sources. Commonly needed for PHH/AAY ration card category applications, plus scholarships and other subsidy schemes. Valid for 3 years in UP.

Documents needed to obtain it

- Aadhaar card (mandatory e-KYC — name and photo auto-fill from UIDAI)
- Self-Declaration Form (Swaprashit Ghoshna Patra) stating total annual family income, downloadable from the eSathi portal footer
- Proof of address
- Recent photograph (or use the Aadhaar photo option)

How to apply (online, via eSathi)

9. Go to edistrict.up.gov.in and click Citizen Login (redirects to esathi.up.gov.in); new users click New User Registration.
10. After logging in, choose Apply for Certificate → Income Certificate (Aay Praman Patra).

11. Select Rural (Gramin) or Urban (Nagariya) based on actual residence — this decides who verifies the application.
12. Fill personal details, upload documents (PDF/JPEG, generally under ~100 KB each), and submit.
13. Field verification is carried out by the Lekhpal (rural) or Revenue Inspector (urban) before the Tehsildar digitally signs and issues the certificate.
14. Track status online using the application number, and download the signed certificate once approved.

Note: Offline option: collect/print the form at your nearest Tehsil office, fill it, attach documents, and submit at the counter. CSC operators may charge an additional Rs. 30–50 service fee.

Source: India Customer Care; edistrictup.in

6.4 Domicile / Residence Certificate (Niwas Praman Patra)

UP recognises two variants: Samanya Niwas Praman Patra (Ordinary Residence Certificate — current address) and Mool Niwas Praman Patra (Permanent/Original Domicile Certificate — ancestral/permanent UP residence). The latter is generally required for state-quota admissions, government job applications, and certain welfare scheme linkages.

Eligibility

- 3 years of continuous residence in Uttar Pradesh, OR
- Born in UP, or parents are permanent UP residents (qualifies regardless of the applicant's own residence duration)

Documents required

- Proof of identity (Aadhaar, Voter ID, Passport, etc.)
- Proof of address (ration card, utility bills, bank passbook, rent agreement)
- Proof of long-term stay (school certificates, property documents, older utility bills)
- Family ID (mandatory on the eSathi portal)
- Self-declaration affidavit of residence

How to apply

15. Visit edistrict.up.gov.in (via esathi.up.gov.in), log in, and select Domicile Certificate under Apply for Certificate.
16. Select Rural or Urban, and enter your Family ID.
17. Fill personal and residence-history details and upload supporting documents.
18. Field verification by the Lekhpal/Revenue Inspector, followed by issue from the Tehsildar's office — typically within about 30 days.

Source: India Customer Care; LegalRaasta — UP Domicile Certificate guides

6.5 Caste Certificate (Jati Praman Patra)

Needed only where reserved-category benefits are being claimed alongside ration/welfare entitlements. Issued by the Tehsildar/SDM/ADM.

- Address proof: Aadhaar, ration card, voter ID, or utility bill
- Identity proof: Aadhaar, PAN, or voter ID
- Self-declaration certificate

- Recent photograph
- Income certificate (for OBC/non-creamy-layer claims)

Online application is generally routed through edistrict.up.gov.in; where online filing isn't available for a particular caste category, applicants submit the form with a Rs. 1.50 court-fee stamp at the local Tehsil office or CSC.

Source: LegalRaasta — UP Caste Certificate guide

6.6 Disability Certificate (for AAY priority classification)

For households where a disabled member is the basis for AAY (poorest-of-the-poor) classification, a disability certificate issued by the Chief Medical Officer (CMO) or a district hospital medical board is typically required alongside standard identity/address documents.

- Application at the CMO office or notified district hospital
- Medical board assessment and disability percentage certification
- Aadhaar and photograph required alongside the medical assessment form

Source: General Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 certification framework as applied at district level

6.7 Death, Birth & Marriage Certificates (for card updates)

These civil registration documents are frequently needed when updating an existing ration card rather than for a fresh application:

- Death Certificate — required to remove a deceased member from the card. Apply via edistrict.up.gov.in (Nagar Nigam/Nagar Palika for urban, Gram Panchayat for rural registration).
- Birth Certificate — required to add a newborn to the family's card. Registration is done with the local municipal body or Gram Panchayat, typically within 21 days of birth for the simplest process.
- Marriage Certificate — supports splitting a household into a new, separate ration card for a newly married couple; can be obtained via the Sub-Registrar's office or edistrict.up.gov.in's marriage registration service.

Source: edistrict.up.gov.in civil registration services — general guidance

7. Step-by-Step: How to Apply for a New Ration Card

7.1 Online Application (fcs.up.gov.in)

19. Go to the official portal: fcs.up.gov.in.
20. Register using your mobile number if you're a new user, and create your login.
21. Look for 'नवीन राशन कार्ड के लिए आवेदन' (Apply for New Ration Card) on the homepage.
22. Fill the application form: head of family details, all family members with Aadhaar numbers, address, LPG/electricity connection details, income, and bank information.
23. Upload the required documents (JPG/PDF, usually under ~200 KB per file).
24. Review all entered details carefully, then submit the form.
25. Note down the application Reference ID / Sandarbh ID shown on the acknowledgement — needed to track status later.

Note: There is no government fee for a new ration card. If anyone demands payment beyond the standard CSC service charge, it may be fraudulent — report it via the helplines in Section 14.

Source: CitizenNest; India Customer Care — application steps

7.2 Offline Application (CSC / Tehsil Supply Office)

26. Visit your nearest Common Service Centre (CSC/Jan Seva Kendra) or the Tehsil (Block) Supply Office.
27. The CSC operator logs into the e-District/FCS system on your behalf and fills the form, or you collect and fill a printed form (separate formats for rural/urban applicants).
28. Submit the filled form with self-attested photocopies of all required documents.
29. Collect the acknowledgement slip bearing your Reference ID.
30. A Supply Inspector (आपूर्ति निरीक्षक) — via the Gram Panchayat Officer in rural areas — carries out field verification, typically within 15–30 days.
31. After verification and approval, your name is added to the NFSA eligibility list and the ration card is issued.

Source: India Customer Care; Tribune India — offline application steps

7.3 Field Verification Process (What Happens Behind the Scenes)

Once an application is submitted (online or offline), it is routed to the local revenue/supply hierarchy for physical verification before approval:

- Rural areas: the Gram Panchayat Officer/Lekhpal verifies household details, income claims, and residence, often visiting the address in person.
- Urban areas: a Revenue Inspector/Supply Inspector conducts the equivalent verification for households within municipal limits.
- Verification typically checks: actual residence at the stated address, family composition against Aadhaar/Family ID records, absence of an existing ration card elsewhere, and rough consistency of the income claim with visible household circumstances.
- The verifying officer submits a report/recommendation to the District Supply Officer (DSO), who approves or rejects the application and assigns the card category (AAY/PHH/EHH).

Source: Compiled from CitizenNest and India Customer Care process descriptions

7.4 Checking Application Status

32. Go to fcs.up.gov.in.
33. Click 'राशन कार्ड आवेदन की स्थिति' (Ration Card Application Status) under Important Links.
34. Enter your Ration ID / Reference ID / Sandarbh ID and the captcha code.
35. Click 'Get OTP', enter the OTP received on your registered mobile number, and submit.
36. Your current status is displayed on screen.

Source: Sarkari Yojana — FCS UP status check steps

7.5 Ration Card Eligibility List / Downloading the Card

Once approved, you can view/search your entry and download the card in a few ways:

- FCS Portal: fcs.up.gov.in → 'राशन कार्ड की पात्रता सूची' → select District → Block/Town → Gram Panchayat/Ward → Fair Price Shop dealer to see the full beneficiary list, or search directly by ration card number with OTP verification.
- DigiLocker: Open the DigiLocker app or digilocker.gov.in, log in with your Aadhaar-linked mobile number, search 'Ration Card', select the issuing department, and fetch the document.
- Mera Ration 2.0 App: Available on Play Store/App Store; log in with Aadhaar-based authentication to view/download your card and check entitlements — useful under ONORC.

Source: Bajaj Finserv; India Customer Care — ration card download methods

8. Fee Structure — Ration Card and Related Certificates

Service	Government Fee	Typical CSC/Jan Seva Kendra Service Charge
New Ration Card issuance	Nil	Approx. Rs. 10–30
Ration card correction/modification	Nil (in most cases)	Approx. Rs. 10–30
Income Certificate (Aay Praman Patra)	Nominal portal fee (varies)	Approx. Rs. 30–50
Domicile Certificate (Niwas Praman Patra)	Nominal portal fee (varies)	Approx. Rs. 20–40
Caste Certificate — offline	Rs. 1.50 court-fee stamp	Approx. Rs. 20
Family ID registration	Nil	Nil (self-service) / minor CSC assistance charge

Note: Exact CSC service charges are not centrally fixed and can vary by operator/district; the figures above are commonly reported ranges from secondary sources, not an official fee notification.

Source: Compiled from LegalRaasta, India Customer Care, and CitizenNest fee references

9. Managing an Existing Ration Card

9.1 Adding a family member

37. Log in at fcs.up.gov.in → Modification section → 'Add Member'.
38. Enter the new member's details and Aadhaar number.
39. Attach supporting document (e.g., birth certificate for a newborn, marriage certificate for a spouse).
40. Submit for verification by the Supply Inspector.

9.2 Removing a member

41. Use the 'Delete Member' option on the same portal.
42. Attach supporting proof — typically a death certificate, or proof of the member's inclusion on a separate new household card.

9.3 Corrections (name, address, category)

Apply through the correction/modification link on fcs.up.gov.in, or at the Tehsil Supply Office, with supporting documents proving the correct detail (e.g., Aadhaar for name spelling).

9.4 Renewal, duplicate card & surrender

- Renewal: use the renewal form on fcs.up.gov.in or edistrict.up.gov.in when a card nears expiry or needs reissue.
- Duplicate/lost card: apply for a duplicate at the Tehsil Supply Office or online, typically with an FIR/police report reference if the original was lost or stolen, plus identity proof.

- Surrender: required before permanently moving to another state (to avoid duplicate-card violations), or when a household is being merged/split.

Source: CitizenNest — UP Ration Card modification steps

10. Digital Systems: e-PoS, Aadhaar Seeding & ONORC

10.1 Electronic Point of Sale (e-PoS)

Fair Price Shops in UP use e-PoS devices that authenticate beneficiaries biometrically (fingerprint/iris) or via OTP before dispensing foodgrain, and log the transaction quantity electronically against the beneficiary's Aadhaar-seeded ration card. UP has also linked e-PoS machines with electronic weighing scales, an initiative highlighted at the national level for improving delivery accuracy of the exact entitled quantity.

10.2 Aadhaar Seeding

Aadhaar seeding — linking each beneficiary's Aadhaar number to their ration card entry — is mandatory nationwide, including in UP, to prevent duplicate/ghost beneficiaries and to enable biometric authentication at the FPS.

10.3 One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC)

ONORC allows ration cardholders to draw their entitlement from any Fair Price Shop in India using Aadhaar-based authentication. Nationally, during 2024, roughly 30 crore portability transactions were recorded over 11 months, delivering around 66 lakh metric tonnes (LMT) of foodgrain through inter-state and intra-state portability under NFSA and PMGKAY combined — with more than 2.5 crore portability transactions recorded per month under PMGKAY foodgrain distribution specifically. Uttar Pradesh, as both a major source state for migrant labour and a large PDS state, participates fully in ONORC.

10.4 Mera Ration 2.0 App & DigiLocker

The Mera Ration 2.0 mobile app (Play Store/App Store) and DigiLocker allow Aadhaar-authenticated cardholders to view entitlements, locate nearby Fair Price Shops, and download a digital copy of the ration card without visiting an office.

Source: PIB — Year-End Review of Department of Food and Public Distribution, 2024 (ONORC transaction volumes); PIB/news reports on UP e-PoS–weighing scale integration

11. Procurement & Supply Chain Behind the PDS

11.1 Minimum Support Price (MSP) & Procurement

Before foodgrain reaches Fair Price Shops, it must first be procured from farmers at the Minimum Support Price (MSP) — a floor price set by the Central Government each season to protect farmer incomes — and stored/transported through the Food Corporation of India (FCI) and, in some states, state procurement agencies under decentralised procurement.

Verified procurement figures

- Rabi Marketing Season (RMS) 2024-25: total wheat procurement across India reached about 266 Lakh Metric Tonnes (LMT), up from 262 LMT in RMS 2023-24 and 188 LMT in RMS 2022-23.
- Uttar Pradesh's wheat procurement in RMS 2024-25 was reported at approximately 9.31 LMT (an interim government release) — a sharp rise from about 2.20 LMT in the previous season — with a separate mid-season figure citing 9.07 LMT as of late May 2024; both figures come from official Consumer Affairs Ministry updates at different points in the procurement window, and reflect UP's traditionally modest share of central-pool wheat procurement compared to Punjab, Haryana, and Madhya Pradesh.
- MSP for wheat, RMS 2024-25: Rs. 2,275 per quintal, benefiting more than 22 lakh farmers nationally with about Rs. 61,000 crore credited directly to farmer bank accounts.
- Kharif Marketing Season 2023-24 (national): paddy procurement exceeded 728 LMT, equivalent to about 489.15 LMT of milled rice, from around 98.26 lakh farmers, with an MSP outflow of roughly Rs. 1,60,000 crore.
- Production context (Economic Survey 2025-26, 2024-25 crop year): Uttar Pradesh is India's largest wheat-producing state, with 35.65 million tonnes (about 30.2% of national wheat production), and the largest rice-producing state, with 20.76 million tonnes (about 13.8% of national rice production).

Note: UP's large production base does not automatically translate into large central-pool procurement volumes — much of UP's wheat and rice moves through open-market and local trade channels rather than government procurement, which is why its MSP procurement figures are modest relative to Punjab/Haryana despite leading national production.

Source: PIB press releases on RMS 2024-25 wheat procurement; Business Standard, Business Today, NewsOnAir coverage of the same government release; Economic Survey 2025-26 Statistical Appendix (Table 1.18)

11.2 Central Issue Price (CIP) & Economic Cost

The Central Issue Price is the rate at which the Centre supplies foodgrain to states for PDS distribution; the difference between CIP and the government's actual economic cost of handling grain is borne as food subsidy.

- In 2002-03 (when CIP first became effective), the economic cost of rice was about Rs. 11.7/kg and wheat about Rs. 8.8/kg.
- By 2024-25 (estimated), the economic cost had risen to about Rs. 39.8/kg for rice and Rs. 27.7/kg for wheat — reflecting storage, transport, and procurement cost inflation over two decades.
- Since foodgrain is now supplied free to NFSA beneficiaries, nearly the entire economic cost is absorbed as central food subsidy.

Source: PRS Legislative Research — Demand for Grants 2024-25 Analysis: Food and Public Distribution

11.3 Storage, Transit & Losses

Foodgrain moves from procurement centres to FCI/state godowns, then onward to Fair Price Shops via a district-level supply chain. Some loss occurs in storage and transit, tracked and reported by FCI for accountability.

- At the national level, FCI has been increasing use of containerised rail ('rakes') and multi-modal transport (coastal shipping plus road) to cut freight costs and transit time, including inter-state movement relevant to UP's supply chain as both a producing and consuming state.
- During 2024 (January–October), FCI moved a total of 10,205 rakes of foodgrain, amounting to approximately 358.93 LMT, nationally.

Source: PIB — Year-End Review of Department of Food and Public Distribution, 2024

12. Fair Price Shop (FPS) System

12.1 Dealer appointment & margins

Fair Price Shop dealers are appointed by the district administration (District Supply Officer) under state PDS control order rules, typically preferring cooperative societies, self-help groups, or individuals meeting eligibility norms set by the state. Dealers earn a commission/margin per quintal of foodgrain sold, partly reimbursed by the central government under NFSA.

12.2 Vigilance & monitoring

- Vigilance Committees at the Fair Price Shop, block, and district levels are meant to include local citizen representatives to monitor stock arrival, distribution, and pricing at FPS outlets.
- e-PoS transaction logs create a digital audit trail that supply departments and vigilance authorities can cross-check against physical stock registers.
- Common malpractices flagged historically include short-weighing, diversion of stock to the open market, and inclusion of ineligible ('bogus') beneficiaries — these are precisely the issues Aadhaar seeding and e-PoS digitisation are designed to reduce.

12.3 Reporting problems at an FPS

Beneficiaries facing short-weighing, denial of entitlement, or dealer misconduct can complain via the toll-free helpline, the fcs.up.gov.in grievance section, or in person to the District Supply Officer (see Section 14).

Source: General PDS control order framework as reported across state PDS guidance and government vigilance mechanisms

13. Facts & Figures (Sourced)

This chapter consolidates verifiable, sourced statistics on India's and Uttar Pradesh's PDS/foodgrain system. Only figures traceable to an official release or a reputable secondary report of one are included; where UP-specific yearly retail-offtake data (i.e., exact tonnes of wheat/rice actually distributed through UP's Fair Price Shops in a given year) was not accessible in verifiable form during research for this document, that gap is stated explicitly rather than filled with an estimate.

Metric	Figure	Period / As of
UP ration cards (total)	≈ 3.6 crore	Recent (2026 secondary aggregation)
UP PDS beneficiaries (total)	≈ 14.6 crore	Recent (2026 secondary aggregation)
UP Fair Price Shops	80,000+	Recent (2026 secondary aggregation)
UP districts covered	75	All districts
UP wheat procurement, RMS 2024-25	≈ 9.31 LMT (interim); ≈ 9.07 LMT (as of late May 2024)	RMS 2024-25 (Apr 2024 onward)
UP wheat procurement, RMS 2023-24	≈ 2.20 LMT	RMS 2023-24
National wheat procurement, RMS 2024-25	≈ 266 LMT	As of Jul 2024 update
National wheat procurement, RMS 2023-24	≈ 262 LMT	RMS 2023-24
National paddy/rice procurement, KMS 2023-24	≈ 728 LMT paddy (≈ 489.15 LMT rice)	KMS 2023-24
UP wheat production	35.65 million tonnes (≈ 30.2% of national)	2024-25 crop year (largest producing state)
UP rice production	20.76 million tonnes (≈ 13.8% of national)	2024-25 crop year (largest producing state)
National NFSA coverage	≈ 80 crore persons (of ≈ 81.34 crore max entitlement)	Recent official figure
National ONORC portability transactions	≈ 30 crore transactions / ≈ 66 LMT foodgrain (11 months)	2024
Economic cost of rice (Centre)	≈ Rs. 39.8/kg (2024-25 est.), up from Rs. 11.7/kg in 2002-03	2024-25 estimate
Economic cost of wheat (Centre)	≈ Rs. 27.7/kg (2024-25 est.), up from Rs. 8.8/kg in 2002-03	2024-25 estimate

Note: UP-specific year-by-year Fair Price Shop offtake (how much wheat/rice was actually distributed to beneficiaries within UP each year) is published by DFPD/FCI in datasets such as data.gov.in's 'State/UT-wise Foodgrains Allocation under NFSA' series, but the live table could not be extracted in verifiable numeric form during this research session (the hosting page renders via JavaScript and the underlying dataset table wasn't retrievable). If this level of granularity is needed for dataset training, the recommended path is downloading the CSV/API export directly from data.gov.in or indiastat.com rather than relying on a secondary summary.

Source: Figures compiled from: PIB press releases (RMS 2024-25 wheat procurement, Year-End Review 2024); Business Standard, Business Today, NewsOnAir (procurement reporting); Economic Survey 2025-26 Statistical Appendix; PRS Legislative Research (Demand for Grants 2024-25); official NFSA coverage figures as reported via Kamaraj IAS Academy summary of government data

14. Grievance Redressal & Helplines

Helpline / Channel	Number / Link	Purpose
UP PDS Toll-Free Helpline	1967 / 1800-1800-150	Ration card & FPS-related complaints (short weighing, denial of ration, etc.)
Online Grievance	fcs.up.gov.in → Grievance section	File a written complaint online and track resolution
District Supply Officer (DSO)	Visit in person with card/application details	Escalation if the toll-free line doesn't resolve the issue
District Grievance Redressal Officer (DGRO)	District Collectorate / Tehsil office	Statutory NFSA grievance officer for entitlement/delivery complaints
CPGRAMS	pgportal.gov.in	Central grievance portal — Dept. of Food & Public Distribution
RTI (Right to Information)	District Supply Officer / Tehsil Food Inspector, as Public Information Officers	Formal request for application/verification status if severely delayed

14.1 Escalation sequence for a stuck application

43. Check status online at fcs.up.gov.in using the Reference ID.
44. If unresolved beyond the normal 15–30 day window, call the toll-free helpline (1967 / 1800-1800-150).
45. File an online grievance at fcs.up.gov.in and/or CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in) — Department of Food & Public Distribution.
46. If still unresolved, file an RTI request under the RTI Act, 2005, addressed to the District Supply Officer and/or Tehsil Food Inspector, requesting the verification report and current file status.
47. A First Appeal under Section 19(1) of the RTI Act can follow if the RTI response is silent or evasive, and a Second Appeal to the State Information Commission thereafter.

Source: India Customer Care; righttoinformation.wiki — grievance/RTI escalation guidance; NFSA statutory DGRO provision

15. Related UP Welfare Schemes Linked via Ration Card / Family ID

Because the ration card and Family ID are used as base identity/eligibility layers for several other UP welfare programmes, applicants working on a broader PDS/welfare chatbot may also want to track these adjoining schemes:

- Pension Schemes (old-age, widow, disability pensions) — often cross-verified against ration card/Family ID data for eligibility and duplicate-beneficiary checks.
- Kanya Sumangala Yojana — a girl-child welfare scheme in UP where family income and Family ID/ration card records may be used as supporting eligibility documentation.

- Scholarship schemes (pre-matric/post-matric, OBC/SC/ST) — income and caste certificates obtained via the same edistrict.up.gov.in workflow described in Section 6 are commonly reused here.

Note: This document's core focus remains the ration card/PDS system; the above is included only as cross-reference context relevant to the wider Public Distribution Scheme (Ration) and Welfare Scheme project.

16. Glossary of Terms

Term (Hindi/English)	Meaning
PDS / TPDS	Public Distribution System / Targeted Public Distribution System — the government's foodgrain distribution mechanism
NFSA	National Food Security Act, 2013 — the central law entitling eligible households to subsidised/free foodgrain
AAY (Antyodaya Anna Yojana)	Priority sub-category for the poorest-of-the-poor households, entitled to 35 kg foodgrain/household/month
PHH (Priority Household)	NFSA category entitled to 5 kg foodgrain/person/month
FPS (Fair Price Shop)	The local retail outlet ('ration dukaan') where beneficiaries collect their monthly entitlement
e-PoS	Electronic Point of Sale device used at FPS for biometric/OTP authentication and transaction logging
ONORC	One Nation One Ration Card — portability scheme letting cardholders use any FPS in India
PMGKAY	Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana — the scheme now merged into NFSA that makes foodgrain free of cost
CIP	Central Issue Price — the rate at which the Centre supplies foodgrain to states
MSP	Minimum Support Price — the floor price the government pays farmers for procurement
FCI	Food Corporation of India — the central agency handling procurement, storage, and movement of foodgrain
Aay Praman Patra	Income Certificate
Niwas / Mool Niwas Praman Patra	Residence Certificate / Permanent Domicile Certificate
Jati Praman Patra	Caste Certificate
Lekhpal	Village-level revenue official who conducts rural field verification
Tehsildar	Sub-district revenue officer who signs/issues most certificates
DSO (District Supply Officer)	District-level officer overseeing ration card approval and PDS administration
DGRO	District Grievance Redressal Officer — statutory NFSA grievance officer
Sandarbh ID / Reference ID	The tracking number issued on submitting a ration card or certificate application
Family ID / Ek Parivar Ek Pehchan	UP's unique 12-digit household identification number
SECC	Socio Economic Caste Census — data source historically used to identify BPL/PHH households

17. Comprehensive FAQ

Is there any fee for a new ration card?

No government fee for issuance itself. CSC/Jan Seva Kendra may charge a nominal service fee (roughly Rs. 10–30).

How long does it take to get a ration card?

Typically 15–30 days after submission, including field verification, though actual timelines can vary by district.

Can I apply if I already have a ration card in another state?

No — a household can hold only one active ration card in India. You must surrender the old card before/while applying fresh in UP.

Is Aadhaar mandatory?

Yes, for the head of family at minimum, and generally for all members being added, for e-KYC and biometric authentication at the Fair Price Shop.

What if my income certificate application is rejected or delayed?

Check the reason on the eSathi status page; common causes are mismatched Aadhaar e-KYC details or incomplete self-declaration. Reapply after correcting the flagged issue, or visit the Tehsil office directly.

Is foodgrain really free now, or subsidised?

Since 1 January 2023, NFSA foodgrain (5 kg/person for PHH, 35 kg/household for AAY) is provided completely free of cost under the PMGKAY–NFSA merger, extended through December 2028.

What is the difference between Samanya Niwas Praman Patra and Mool Niwas Praman Patra?

Samanya Niwas Praman Patra proves your current residential address; Mool Niwas Praman Patra proves permanent/ancestral domicile in UP and is generally what's needed for state-quota admissions and government jobs.

Can a migrant worker from UP use their ration card outside the state?

Yes, under ONORC, a UP ration card can be used at any Fair Price Shop in India with Aadhaar-based authentication, without needing to apply for a new card in the destination state.

What happens if the Fair Price Shop dealer gives less quantity than entitled?

This is a reportable violation — complain via the toll-free helpline (1967 / 1800-1800-150) or the fcs.up.gov.in grievance section; under NFSA, a Food Security Allowance may also be payable if entitlement isn't supplied.

Does the ration card expire?

Cards can need renewal/reissue over time (e.g., damaged card, long-unused card flagged in periodic verification drives); use the renewal option on fcs.up.gov.in or edistrict.up.gov.in when required.

Who decides whether a household gets AAY or PHH classification?

The District Supply Officer, based on the field verification report from the Lekhpal/Supply Inspector and the eligibility criteria set by the state (income, vulnerability indicators such as disability/widowhood/old age, and NFSA quotas).

Can women apply as head of household?

Yes — NFSA specifically provides that the eldest woman of the household, aged 18 or above, is to be recognised as the head of household for ration card issuance, unless no adult woman is available in the family.

What is the role of the Family ID in the ration card process?

Family ID consolidates household data across schemes; many certificate applications (e.g., Domicile Certificate) now mandate entering the Family ID, and it can also link the household to other welfare schemes beyond PDS.

Is there a helpline specifically for senior citizens or SC/ST grievances related to welfare schemes?

Yes, at the national level there are dedicated helplines such as the National Helpline for Senior Citizens (14567/Elderline) and the SC/ST Atrocities Prevention National Helpline (14566), alongside the general PDS helpline for ration-specific issues.

Source: Compiled from CitizenNest, India Customer Care, edistrictup.in, dfpd.gov.in NFSA text, and PIB releases referenced throughout this document

18. Key Official Portals

- fcs.up.gov.in — Department of Food & Civil Supplies, UP (ration card application, status, eligibility list, download, grievance)
- edistrict.up.gov.in / esathi.up.gov.in — e-District UP portal (income, domicile, caste certificates and other services)
- familyid.up.gov.in — UP Family ID (Ek Parivar Ek Pehchan) registration
- nfsa.up.gov.in — NFSA beneficiary/eligibility list by district
- digilocker.gov.in — Digital document wallet (download issued ration card)
- pgportal.gov.in (CPGRAMS) — Central grievance redressal portal
- dfpd.gov.in — Department of Food & Public Distribution, Government of India (NFSA text, PMGKAY notifications)
- data.gov.in — Open Government Data Platform (for raw NFSA allocation/offtake datasets, where CSV/API export is needed)

19. Sources Consulted

This guide summarises publicly available information from the official portals listed above and the following secondary sources, current as of July 2026. Government rules, fee structures, income thresholds, and procurement/production figures change regularly — always confirm current details on the official fcs.up.gov.in / edistrict.up.gov.in / dfpd.gov.in portals before relying on this document for a live decision or for exact current-year statistics.

- CitizenNest — UP Ration Card Apply Online guide (citizennest.com)
- India Customer Care — UP Ration Card, Income Certificate, Domicile Certificate guides (g.indiacustomer care.com)
- ClearTax — UP Ration Card overview (cleartax.in)
- Tribune India — UP Ration Card application process (tribuneindia.com)
- Sarkari Yojana — FCS UP status/list check steps (sarkariyojana.com)
- LegalRaasta — UP Domicile Certificate & Caste Certificate guides (legalraasta.com)
- edistrictup.in — e-District UP certificate guides
- egovtschemes.com / pppfamilyid.com — UP Family ID registration guides
- righttoinformation.wiki — Grievance/RTI escalation guidance for stuck ration card applications
- Bajaj Finserv — Ration Card Download UP guide (bajajfinserv.in)
- Department of Food & Public Distribution (dfpd.gov.in) — National Food Security Act, 2013, full text and NFSA free-foodgrain notification S.O. 6148(E)
- Press Information Bureau (pib.gov.in) — RMS 2024-25 wheat procurement releases; Year-End Review of Department of Food and Public Distribution, 2024
- Business Standard, Business Today, NewsOnAir, Krishi Jagran, Prokerala, New Kerala — news coverage of the same PIB procurement releases (cross-checked for consistency)
- PRS Legislative Research — Demand for Grants 2024-25 Analysis: Food and Public Distribution (CIP/economic cost figures)
- Economic Survey 2025-26, Statistical Appendix, Table 1.18 (indiabudget.gov.in) — state-wise crop production figures
- PMFIAS, PubAdmin Institute, Business Standard, Grokipedia, Kamaraj IAS Academy — NFSA/PMGKAY historical and legal background (cross-checked across sources)
- data.gov.in — Open Government Data Platform (NFSA allocation dataset identified but not numerically extractable in this session; recommended for direct CSV/API download if exact UP-level yearly offtake figures are required)